

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY

Under Graduate — Semester I Examination, 2024-25 / 2025-26 (NEP)

ABILITY ENHANCEMENT COURSE (AEC)**Paper Code: ENGAE-11 : Writing Skills**

Time: 1.5 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

Instructions: Answer all 70 Multiple Choice Questions. Each question carries equal marks (1 mark each).

Question 1. What should the conclusion of an essay primarily do? [1]

- (A) Summarize the main points and restate the thesis in a new way
- (B) Introduce new arguments
- (C) Ask unrelated questions
- (D) End abruptly without summary

Question 2. Which of the following is the correct sequence of story development? [1]

- (A) Conflict o Ending o Climax o Beginning
- (B) Beginning o Conflict o Climax o Ending
- (C) Climax o Beginning o Conflict o Ending
- (D) Ending o Conflict o Climax o Beginning

Question 3. In job application letters, which paragraph typically outlines your skills and experiences? [1]

- (A) Salutation
- (B) Body paragraph(s)
- (C) Closing
- (D) Subject line

Question 4. What is the main purpose of a cover letter? [1]

- (A) To introduce yourself and explain why you are qualified for the job
- (B) To list your entire life history
- (C) To summarize your financial status
- (D) To ask for personal favors

Question 5. What is the purpose of the “CC” field in an email? [1]

- (A) To send an email to a friend
- (B) To add recipients who should be informed but do not need to take action
- (C) To send an email to your neighbor
- (D) To mark an email as important

Question 6. The process of revising an essay typically includes which of the following? [1]

- (A) Checking for grammar, clarity, and logical coherence
- (B) Adding unrelated topics
- (C) Reducing word count without purpose
- (D) Changing main ideas repeatedly

Question 7. Which of the following is an example of an official/formal letter? [1]

- (A) Letter to a business manager or university authority
- (B) Letter to a sibling
- (C) Birthday invitation to a friend
- (D) Personal diary entry

Question 8. In email writing, what does “BCC” stand for? [1]

- (A) Blind Carbon Copy
- (B) Basic Carbon Copy
- (C) Blind Courtesy Communication
- (D) Business Communication Copy

Question 9. What is the primary focus of Précis writing? [1]

- (A) Condensing a text to its essential ideas without altering the original meaning
- (B) Adding personal opinions and commentary
- (C) Expanding the length of the original text
- (D) Changing the author’s viewpoint

Question 10. What is the ideal length of a Précis relative to the original passage? [1]

- (A) Approximately one-third of the original passage
- (B) Half of the original passage
- (C) Same length as the original passage
- (D) Double the length of the original passage

Question 11. Which tone is appropriate for formal business letters? [1]

- (A) Polite, professional, and clear
- (B) Sarcastic and informal
- (C) Overly emotional and dramatic
- (D) Casual and humorous

Question 12. What element should be included in the header of a formal letter? [1]

- (A) Sender's address, date, and receiver's address
- (B) Informal greeting only
- (C) Personal hobbies
- (D) Social media handles

Question 13. In essay writing, what is a thesis statement? [1]

- (A) A single sentence that summarizes the main point or claim of the essay
- (B) A list of references
- (C) The concluding sentence of a paragraph
- (D) An introductory greeting

Question 14. What type of essay aims to convince the reader to accept a specific viewpoint? [1]

- (A) Persuasive / Argumentative Essay
- (B) Descriptive Essay
- (C) Narrative Essay
- (D) Expository Essay

Question 15. What type of essay describes a person, place, object, or event vividly? [1]

- (A) Descriptive Essay
- (B) Persuasive Essay
- (C) Argumentative Essay
- (D) Analytical Essay

Question 16. What is the first step in the writing process? [1]

- (A) Pre-writing / Brainstorming
- (B) Proofreading
- (C) Publishing

(D) Final drafting

Question 17. Which salutation is most appropriate for a formal letter when the recipient's name is unknown? [1]

(A) Dear Sir / Madam

(B) Hey friend

(C) To Whom It May Concern

(D) Both (A) and (C)

Question 18. What is considered inappropriate in professional email communication? [1]

(A) Using ALL CAPS (which implies shouting) and informal slang

(B) Clear subject line

(C) Professional closing

(D) Checking spelling before sending

Question 19. What should be avoided when writing a précis? [1]

(A) Inserting personal opinions, extra examples, or direct quotes

(B) Maintaining original meaning

(C) Concise summary

(D) Using clear language

Question 20. In note-taking, what is the Cornell Method? [1]

(A) A structured format dividing notes into cues, notes, and summary sections

(B) Writing full paragraphs continuously

(C) Drawing random pictures

(D) Recording audio only

Question 21. What is the primary goal of proofreading? [1]

(A) Identifying and correcting spelling, punctuation, and grammatical errors

(B) Rewriting the entire text from scratch

(C) Changing font color

(D) Increasing page numbers

Question 22. What is a paragraph's "topic sentence"? [1]

(A) The sentence that states the main idea of the paragraph

(B) The last sentence of an essay

- (C) A transition phrase between paragraphs
- (D) A random supporting detail

Question 23. Coherence in writing refers to: [1]

- (A) Logical flow and smooth connection between sentences and ideas
- (B) Using complex vocabulary only
- (C) High word count
- (D) Formatting margins correctly

Question 24. What is plagiarism? [1]

- (A) Using someone else's work or ideas without proper acknowledgment
- (B) Writing an original essay
- (C) Citing academic sources correctly
- (D) Peer reviewing a classmate's draft

Question 25. Which element is essential in a formal report? [1]

- (A) Title page, executive summary, findings, and recommendations
- (B) Personal anecdotes
- (C) Fictional story elements
- (D) Informal chat transcript

Question 26. What is the function of transitional words (*however, furthermore, consequently*) in writing? [1]

- (A) To guide the reader and show relationships between ideas
- (B) To fill up space
- (C) To make sentences longer
- (D) To confuse the reader

Question 27. In professional communication, what is an inappropriate email signature? [1]

- (A) Using informal nicknames or inspirational quotes in business emails
- (B) Full name and job title
- (C) Contact phone number
- (D) Organization address

Question 28. What is the purpose of an abstract in academic papers? [1]

- (A) A concise summary of the entire research paper or article

- (B) A list of author biography
- (C) Detailed raw data tables
- (D) Acknowledgments page

Question 29. Which voice is generally preferred in objective formal academic writing? [1]

- (A) Passive voice or third-person objective perspective
- (B) First-person subjective perspective
- (C) Second-person direct address (“you”)
- (D) Conversational dialogue

Question 30. What does “conciseness” in writing mean? [1]

- (A) Expressing ideas clearly using as few words as necessary without losing meaning
- (B) Writing extremely short sentences only
- (C) Skipping important details
- (D) Using repetitive words

Question 31. Which format is commonly used for formatting business letters? [1]

- (A) Block format (left-aligned paragraphs without indentation)
- (B) Double-spaced poetry format
- (C) Right-aligned text format
- (D) Center-aligned text format

Question 32. In story writing, what is the “climax”? [1]

- (A) The turning point or moment of highest emotional tension in the plot
- (B) The introduction of characters
- (C) The final resolution
- (D) The title page

Question 33. What is a “hook” in the introduction of an essay? [1]

- (A) An opening sentence designed to capture the reader’s attention
- (B) The final conclusion statement
- (C) A footnote citation
- (D) A definition of a common word

Question 34. What is the purpose of a bibliography or reference list? [1]

- (A) To give credit to all sources consulted during research
- (B) To increase word count
- (C) To list future books to read
- (D) To summarize the thesis

Question 35. What is “freewriting”? [1]

- (A) Writing continuously without worrying about grammar, spelling, or structure to generate ideas
- (B) Copying text from a textbook
- (C) Writing a polished final draft directly
- (D) Writing without a pen

Question 36. What is the main characteristic of narrative writing? [1]

- (A) Telling a story or recounting a sequence of events
- (B) Comparing two statistical tables
- (C) Describing a scientific apparatus
- (D) Formulating an equation

Question 37. When writing a letter of complaint, what tone should be maintained? [1]

- (A) Firm, polite, and objective with specific facts and evidence
- (B) Angry and abusive
- (C) Sarcastic and threatening
- (D) Apologetic and passive

Question 38. In e-communication, what does “netiquette” refer to? [1]

- (A) Acceptable rules of polite and professional behavior online
- (B) Internet connection speed
- (C) Web design techniques
- (D) Email encryption software

Question 39. What is a mnemonic device in note-taking and learning? [1]

- (A) A memory aid or technique (such as acronyms) to help remember information
- (B) A digital tablet for taking notes
- (C) A type of dictionary
- (D) A grammatical rule

Question 40. What does it mean to “reply all” to an email? [1]

- (A) Sending your response to the sender and every person listed in To and CC fields
- (B) Sending an email to your entire contact list
- (C) Deleting the email chain
- (D) Forwarding to an external party

Question 41. Why should you avoid excessive use of jargon/technical words in e-writing for general audiences? [1]

- (A) It can confuse readers and reduce clarity
- (B) It makes writing too easy
- (C) It reduces file size
- (D) It speeds up internet speed

Question 42. What is the purpose of the executive summary in a formal report? [1]

- (A) To summarize key findings and recommendations for busy executives
- (B) To list index terms
- (C) To show raw data sheets
- (D) To present budget receipts

Question 43. Which of the following is the most important characteristic of an effective précis? [1]

- (A) Brevity, clarity, and faithfulness to the original meaning
- (B) Creative additions
- (C) Expressing personal bias
- (D) Ornate language

Question 44. What is mind mapping used for in pre-writing? [1]

- (A) Visually organizing ideas and brainstorming connections around a central concept
- (B) Correcting punctuation errors
- (C) Formatting citations
- (D) Printing final documents

Question 45. When completing a story, which element is most important to consider? [1]

- (A) Ensuring a logical resolution that ties up main conflict lines
- (B) Adding new characters at the last line

- (C) Changing the setting abruptly
- (D) Leaving sentences incomplete

Question 46. In which situation would it be appropriate to use the “BCC” option in an email? [1]

- (A) Sending an email to a large group while protecting recipients’ privacy
- (B) Emailing your supervisor directly
- (C) Submitting an assignment to a teacher
- (D) Asking a coworker a question

Question 47. Which of the following is an example of a formal writing style? [1]

- (A) “The experiment demonstrated a significant increase in efficiency.”
- (B) “Hey guys, the test was totally awesome!”
- (C) “I don’t think it’s gonna work at all.”
- (D) “LOL that’s so cool.”

Question 48. What is an email? [1]

- (A) A method of exchanging digital messages over internet networks
- (B) A physical letter sent via postal post
- (C) A voice call recording
- (D) A printed newspaper article

Question 49. Which of the following is an essential step in writing a précis? [1]

- (A) Reading the original text carefully to grasp the central theme
- (B) Changing facts to fit your view
- (C) Translating text into another language
- (D) Adding fictional details

Question 50. When writing a précis, how should you handle the author’s examples and anecdotes? [1]

- (A) Omit unnecessary details, examples, and anecdotes to maintain brevity
- (B) Include every example in full detail
- (C) Add extra examples of your own
- (D) Replace them with personal stories

Question 51. Which of the following should you do after writing a précis draft? [1]

- (A) Compare it with the original text to ensure accuracy and word limit adherence
- (B) Throw it away without checking
- (C) Double the word count
- (D) Add illustrations

Question 52. Which of these should be avoided in a good essay? [1]

- (A) Vague thesis statements, logical fallacies, and informal slang
- (B) Clear paragraph transitions
- (C) Evidence-backed arguments
- (D) Proper introduction and conclusion

Question 53. Which of the following is NOT typically part of a standard essay structure? [1]

- (A) Vague, disconnected topic sentences
- (B) Introduction with thesis statement
- (C) Body paragraphs with evidence
- (D) Conclusion summarizing key points

Question 54. What is a “dangling modifier” in grammar? [1]

- (A) A modifier that misleads or lacks a clear word to modify in the sentence
- (B) A type of punctuation mark
- (C) A strong verb
- (D) A transition word

Question 55. In business correspondence, what does “FYI” stand for? [1]

- (A) For Your Information
- (B) For Your Inspection
- (C) From Your Inbox
- (D) Final Yearly Income

Question 56. What is the purpose of an appendix in a formal report? [1]

- (A) To include supplementary material (raw data, questionnaires, or detailed tables)
- (B) To list main chapters
- (C) To serve as the cover page
- (D) To state author qualifications

Question 57. Which punctuation mark is used to join two independent clauses without a conjunction? [1]

- (A) Semicolon (;)
- (B) Comma (,)
- (C) Hyphen (-)
- (D) Apostrophe (')

Question 58. What is active voice? [1]

- (A) A sentence structure where the subject performs the action of the verb
- (B) A sentence structure where the subject receives the action
- (C) A sentence without a verb
- (D) A question sentence

Question 59. What is the benefit of outlining before writing an essay? [1]

- (A) Helps structure ideas logically and ensures coherent flow
- (B) Eliminates the need for proofreading
- (C) Automatically fixes spelling errors
- (D) Reduces word count to zero

Question 60. What is a prerequisite for effective note-taking during a lecture? [1]

- (A) Active listening and identifying main ideas/keywords
- (B) Writing down every single spoken word verbatim
- (C) Sleeping during the presentation
- (D) Copying classmate's notes later

Question 61. In formal writing, why should contractions (e.g., *don't*, *can't*, *won't*) be avoided? [1]

- (A) Contractions represent an informal tone suited for casual communication
- (B) They are grammatically illegal
- (C) They confuse spellcheckers
- (D) They increase word count

Question 62. What is the primary purpose of descriptive writing? [1]

- (A) To create a vivid sensory image in the reader's mind using detailed imagery
- (B) To present statistical data

- (C) To argue a legal case
- (D) To write computer code

Question 63. What is the role of a peer reviewer? [1]

- (A) To provide constructive feedback on clarity, structure, and content of a draft
- (B) To assign final grades
- (C) To rewrite the paper entirely
- (D) To reject the paper without comments

Question 64. What is “brainstorming”? [1]

- (A) A creative technique for generating a wide list of ideas on a topic freely
- (B) A medical test
- (C) Formatting a document
- (D) Checking dictionary definitions

Question 65. What should be avoided while writing a précis? [1]

- (A) Using complex technical words and adding personal commentary
- (B) Retaining original meaning
- (C) Summarizing concisely
- (D) Presenting key ideas clearly

Question 66. Which of the following are characteristics of a formal writing style? [1]

- (A) Objective tone and avoidance of informal slang/contractions
- (B) Excessive use of emojis
- (C) Casual conversational slang
- (D) Random capitalization

Question 67. What is the purpose of peer review in the writing process? [1]

- (A) To gain fresh perspective and identify areas for improvement in clarity and logic
- (B) To copy another student’s work
- (C) To skip final editing
- (D) To change the topic completely

Question 68. What is the most appropriate tone for a formal business letter? [1]

- (A) Professional, respectful, and clear

- (B) Overly casual
- (C) Aggressive
- (D) Humorous and silly

Question 69. What is the most important factor in effective note-taking? [1]

- (A) Capturing essential concepts and key supporting details clearly
- (B) Using fancy handwriting
- (C) Using expensive notebooks
- (D) Writing at maximum speed

Question 70. Which of the following is a common mistake in essay writing? [1]

- (A) Lack of a clear thesis statement and weak paragraph transitions
- (B) Writing with clarity
- (C) Organizing paragraphs logically
- (D) Proofreading before submission